



Ember the Baby Dragon

A chunky, big-headed baby dragon with a stubby snout, scalloped wings and a ridge of spikes down the back — she sits, with folding haunches and splayed front legs

Design Code NS 08

US terms

Intermediate

4-5 hours

Stitch counts verified

About 11 cm (4.3 in) tall seated • 12.5 cm (5 in) wingspan • 5 cm (2 in) tail • a sitting dragon — her body rests on the table and her legs pose rather than lift her

Worsted #4 sage ~30 g • cream/pale gold contrast ~20 g + 10 g • 3.5 mm hook • two 10 mm safety eyes

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SAFETY — 10 mm SAFETY EYES

Ember uses 10 mm safety eyes, which are a small part and a choking hazard. Lock the washers from the inside before the head is joined to the body, and pull-test each eye.

She is a decorative piece, not a toy for young children, and has not been tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. To give her to a child, embroider the eyes instead and check every seam first.

Materials

- **Main yarn:** worsted #4, about 30 g used (buy a 50 g ball) — sage green, dusty teal, lilac or charcoal. The extra allows for tails, sewing and a second attempt.
- **Belly & wings:** worsted #4, about 20 g in a contrast cream or pale gold.
- **Spikes:** worsted #4, about 10 g in the contrast colour (horns, spikes and wings match).
- **Hook:** 3.5 mm (US E/4).
- **Eyes:** 2 x 10 mm safety eyes — slit-pupil dragon eyes if you can get them.
- **Also needed:** polyester fibre fill about 10 g; tapestry needle; stitch markers; pins.

Gauge & size check**About 4.5 mm per stitch and 4.3 mm per round.**

Check on the body after Rnd 5 — 30 stitches should measure about 43 mm across when stuffed. If your stitches are wider, crochet more tightly or drop to a 3.0 mm hook or the stuffing will show.

Abbreviations — US terms

MR magic ring • ch chain • sc single crochet • hdc half double crochet • dc double crochet • inc increase (2 sc in one st) • dec invisible decrease • sl st slip stitch • FO fasten off • (n) stitch count at round end.

Construction at a glance

- **Spiral.** work in a continuous spiral unless a row says to turn; mark the first stitch of every round. Work every stitch through both loops unless a note says otherwise.
- **Flat pieces.** the wings and the spike strip are the exceptions — both are worked flat, in turned rows.

The techniques that make this pattern

- **1. The magic ring** — every piece begins with a magic ring; pull the tail tight once the first round is complete.
- **2. Work in a spiral** — keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round; there is no join to count from.
- **3. Matched open joins** — Ember's head and her neck are BOTH left open at 18 stitches, so the two edges are the same size and can be ladder-stitched together cleanly. This is the single most important structural detail — the head is heavy and this joint carries all of it. Do not close the head down to a point; stop at 18 stitches.
- **4. How the size adds up** — body Rnds 1-13 = 13 rnd x 4.3 mm = 56 mm; head Rnds 1-11 = 11 rnd x 4.3 mm = 47 mm; seated height head + body ~ 103 mm = 11 cm.
Wingspan 45 + 34 + 45 ~ 124 mm = 12.5 cm. Tail 12 rnd x 4.3 mm = 52 mm = 5 cm.

Why the head stays open at 18

Closing a heavy dragon head down to 6 stitches leaves a small gathered point sewn to a wide neck ring — a tiny seam carrying a big head, which is exactly why a dragon's head flops. Stopping the head at 18 stitches matches the 18-stitch neck, so the ladder-stitched join is strong and even.

1 · Head — worked top-down and LEFT OPEN at 18 stitches

Do not close it and do not fasten off. A big head is what makes a dragon read as a baby dragon. Two straight rounds only, then the decreases.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	30	
6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	36	head at full width
7	sc in each st around	36	eyes at R7-R8
8	sc in each st around	36	
9	[4 sc, dec] x 6	30	
10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	24	stuff firmly
11	[2 sc, dec] x 6	18	LEAVE OPEN — matches neck

Finish: stuff the head firmly. Leave the open 18-stitch edge for sewing to the body's neck (a long tail is optional). The snout is sewn on next, then the eyes, BEFORE the head is joined.

2 · Snout — main colour, make 1

Rnd	Instruction	Sts
1	6 sc in MR	6
2	[sc, inc] x 3	9
3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	12
4	sc in each st around	12
5	sc in each st around	12

Fasten off with a long tail and stuff lightly. Pin centred on Rnds 8-11 of the head, just below the eye line, and sew all the way around. It must project past the curve of the head, not sit flush — a dragon without a projecting snout reads as a bear. Embroider two small nostrils at the tip.

3 · Body — worked bottom-up, neck left open at 18 stitches

Pack the neck firmly before you join the head — a soft neck is what lets the head flop forward.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	tail attaches R4-R6
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	30	full width — check gauge
6	sc in each st around	30	back legs at R6
7	sc in each st around	30	
8	sc in each st around	30	front legs at R8
9	sc in each st around	30	
10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	24	wings at R10-R11
11	sc in each st around	24	
12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	18	stuff firmly
13	sc in each st around	18	LEAVE THE NECK OPEN

Fasten off with a 40 cm tail; do not close. When you join the head, ladder-stitch all the way around and then make a second pass and pull it tight — this joint carries the whole head.

4 · Legs — make 4 (back stop Rnd 6, front work Rnds 7-8)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	all four
2	[sc, inc] x 3	9	all four
3	sc in each st around	9	all four
4	sc in each st around	9	all four
5	sc in each st around	9	all four
6	sc in each st around	9	BACK legs finish here
7	sc in each st around	9	front legs only
8	sc in each st around	9	front legs only

Finish: stuff the lower half lightly, flatten the top 3 stitches, fasten off with a long tail. The pairs are different lengths on purpose: back legs (6 rnd / 26 mm) attach at Rnd 6, 26 mm up; front legs (8 rnd / 34 mm) attach at Rnd 8, 34 mm up. A higher join needs a longer leg so all four feet reach the table. Sew each pair about 8 stitches apart; angle the back legs under as haunches and the front legs slightly forward. The body rests on the table — the legs pose, they don't lift her.

5 • Horns — contrast colour, make 2

R1: 4 sc in MR (4). R2: sc around (4). R3: [sc, inc] x 2 (6). R4: sc around (6). R5: sc around (6). Do not stuff; fasten off with a long tail. Sew to the crown of the head, 6 stitches apart, angled back.

6 · Tail — contrast-free, worked from the tip up so it tapers naturally

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	4 sc in MR	4	tip
2	sc in each st around	4	
3	[sc, inc] x 2	6	
4	sc in each st around	6	
5	sc in each st around	6	
6	[2 sc, inc] x 2	8	
7	sc in each st around	8	
8	sc in each st around	8	
9	[3 sc, inc] x 2	10	
10	sc in each st around	10	
11	sc in each st around	10	
12	sc in each st around	10	base

Finish: stuff lightly, fasten off with a long tail, flatten the open end and sew it to the back of the body at Rnds 4–6.

7 • Wings — contrast colour, worked flat, make 2

Ch 11. Work in turned rows (ch 1 and turn at each row end):

Row 1: from the 2nd ch, sc in 4, hdc in 3, dc in 3 (10).

Row 2: sc in 3, hdc in 3, dc in 4 (10).

Row 3: sc in 2, hdc in 4, dc in 4 (10).

Row 4 (scalloped edge): sl st in the first 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) all in the next st, sl st in the next 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) all in the next st, sl st in the last 4. Fasten off with a 25 cm tail.

The scallop maths

The slip-stitch anchors are $2 + 2 + 4 = 8$ stitches; the two shells each fan from a single stitch (2 more), so all 10 stitches of Row 3 are consumed and nothing is left over. Pin the straight inner edge across Rnds 10–11 and sew the WHOLE edge so the scalloped edge stays free.

8 • Spike strip — one continuous ridge from crown to tail tip

Nine spikes: 3 on the head, 4 on the body, 2 on the tail. Ch 4, sc in the 2nd ch from the hook, then work this group NINE times: ch 4, sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook, sc in the next ch, hdc in the next ch. Then sc in the next 2 and fasten off with a long tail.

Each group makes one small cone (about 10 mm tall); the last stitch of one group is where the next begins, so the ten chain-4 units form one continuous ridge with no gaps. The strip is about 13.5–15 cm long — slightly under the crown-to-tail path, so it goes on slightly snug. PIN it from crown to tail tip first; if it runs short add one more spike (about 13.5 mm), if long unpick from the plain end. The spikes deliberately touch — do not add plain stitches between them.

9 • Assembly — work in this order

- **1 Snout:** to the head, centred on Rnds 8-11, below the eye line.
- **2 Eyes:** between Rnds 7 and 8, 8 stitches apart, just above the snout. Fit the washers BEFORE the head is joined — once closed you cannot reach inside.
- **3 Horns:** to the crown, 6 stitches apart, angled back.
- **4 Head to body:** both edges open at 18 stitches. Pack the neck firmly, seat the head and ladder-stitch around, then a second tight pass.
- **5 Legs:** back pair to Rnd 6, front pair to Rnd 8, angled as described.
- **6 Tail:** to the back of the body at Rnds 4-6.
- **7 Wings:** across Rnds 10-11, sewn along the whole straight edge.
- **8 Spike strip LAST:** pin from crown to tail tip before you sew a single stitch.

Before you sew — lay every component out and check

1 head (open at 18) • 1 snout • 1 body (open neck at 18) • 4 legs (2 short, 2 long) • 2 horns • 1 tail
• 2 wings • 1 spike strip of 10 cones.

Colorways

 Sage green  Dusty teal  Lilac  Charcoal  Blush pink

Troubleshooting

- **Head flops forward.** pack the neck firmly before closing and make the second ladder-stitch pass tight. If it still moves, the edges did not match — both head and neck must be open at 18 stitches.
- **Rocks back onto haunches.** the legs are all the same length and they cannot be. Back legs attach 26 mm up, front 34 mm up — work the back legs 6 rounds and the front 8.
- **Will not sit.** legs sewn too high, or the base is under-stuffed. Back legs on Rnd 6, front on Rnd 8; keep the lower body firm enough to sit on.
- **Wings droop.** sew along the whole straight inner edge, not just the top corner.
- **Spike strip is wrong length / curves.** it is ten chain-4 units worked end to end (not a single 40-chain). Pin the entire strip from crown to tail before sewing; add or unpick a spike as needed. This is the most visible seam.
- **Looks like a bear.** the snout is missing or under-stuffed — it must project past the dome of the head.
- **Stuffing shows through.** gauge too loose — 30 stitches should measure 43 mm across. Crochet tighter or drop to a 3.0 mm hook.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, and every size claim against the stated gauge.

Check	Result
Head Rnds 1-11: 6 → 36 → 18 (left open, matches neck)	✓ verified
Body Rnds 1-13: 6 → 30 → 18 (left open)	✓ verified
Legs 9 sts: back 6 rnds = 26 mm, front 8 rnds = 34 mm	✓ verified
Tail Rnds 1-12: 4 → 10; 12 rnds = 52 mm = 5 cm	✓ verified
Wing rows 10 sts; Row 4 scallops consume 2+1+2+1+4 = 10	✓ verified
Spike strip = 10 ch-4 cone units (1 + 9 groups)	✓ verified
Sizes: head 47.3 mm + body 55.9 mm = 103 mm seated; wingspan 124 mm	✓ verified
Gauge probe: 30 sts ≈ 42.9 mm across when stuffed	✓ verified

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SAFETY REMINDER

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71) and uses 10 mm safety eyes. Finished items made for sale must be assessed by the seller against local toy-safety laws; for young children, embroider the eyes.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #EmberTheBabyDragon — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.

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